

How to Use This Appendix

This appendix adds practice exercises, phrase banks, study plans and reference notes aligned with the main guide. Work through one section per study session and review your notes weekly.

Extended Study Material

The following sections were prepared by Mubashir Mehdi for LifeWithBooks to supplement this guide with additional explanations, examples and practice. Work through them after reading the main chapters.

Speaking Like Americans Actually Speak

McGraw-Hill's Conversational American English focuses on the spoken language that Americans actually use in daily life - the contractions, reductions, idioms, slang and small-talk patterns that textbooks often skip. It contains over 3,000 expressions organized into more than 100 everyday situations.

Organized by Real Situations

Chapters cover situations like greeting people and saying goodbye, making introductions, talking on the phone, accepting and declining invitations, discussing the weather, eating out, shopping, visiting the doctor, talking about work, expressing feelings and opinions, handling emergencies, and dozens more.

Within each situation, expressions are grouped by communication function - so under 'Eating Out' you will find phrases for getting a table, ordering food, asking about the menu, complaining about service, asking for the check, and tipping. Each expression includes a usage note explaining the level of formality and when it is appropriate.

Building Natural Fluency

The book is designed for reference and study. You can look up a specific situation when you need it, or read through entire chapters to absorb the patterns. An alphabetical index of all expressions makes it easy to find any phrase. Pronunciation tips throughout help learners with the rhythm, stress and intonation that make spoken American English sound natural rather than bookish.

Topic Vocabulary Sets

1. achievement, accomplish, milestone, setback, perseverance
2. ambiguous, clarify, precise, vague, interpret
3. benefit, drawback, advantage, trade-off, consequence
4. collaborate, coordinate, delegate, contribute, facilitate
5. diverse, homogeneous, inclusive, representative, demographic
6. emphasize, highlight, understate, exaggerate, convey
7. feasible, viable, impractical, realistic, ambitious

8. genuine, authentic, artificial, sincere, deceptive
9. hypothesis, evidence, conclude, assume, verify
10. implement, execute, postpone, initiate, abandon
11. justify, rationalize, defend, criticize, acknowledge
12. keen, enthusiastic, reluctant, indifferent, passionate
13. legitimate, valid, questionable, lawful, ethical
14. moderate, extreme, gradual, sudden, substantial
15. notion, concept, perception, misconception, insight
16. objective, subjective, impartial, biased, neutral
17. persistent, consistent, sporadic, intermittent, steady
18. qualify, meet requirements, eligible, exempt, comply
19. reluctant, willing, eager, hesitant, determined
20. significant, negligible, minor, major, noteworthy

Collocation Practice

Match the verb to the natural noun partner:

make - a decision, progress, a mistake, an effort

do - homework, research, your best, damage

take - a break, responsibility, notes, action

have - a meeting, an impact, fun, difficulty

give - advice, a presentation, permission, feedback

pay - attention, a compliment, the bill, a visit

keep - a promise, calm, records, in touch

break - a habit, the news, a record, the law

Conversation Topic Prompts

1. Daily routines and time management
2. Favorite foods and cooking habits
3. Travel experiences and dream destinations
4. Work, study and career goals
5. Technology and social media use
6. Health, fitness and sleep
7. Movies, music and entertainment
8. Family traditions and celebrations
9. Environmental issues and recycling
10. Learning languages and study tips
11. Friendship and social life
12. Money, saving and budgeting
13. Hobbies and creative projects
14. News and current events (neutral topics)
15. Childhood memories
16. City life versus countryside
17. Public transport and commuting
18. Shopping online versus in stores
19. Stress and relaxation methods

20. Future plans for the next five years

Sample Dialogues

Dialogue A - At work

- A: Do you have a minute to discuss the timeline?
B: Sure. I think we can finish by Friday if we prioritize testing.
A: What risks should we mention in the report?
B: Mainly delivery delays and budget limits.

Dialogue B - Daily life

- A: Have you tried the new cafe on Main Street?
B: Not yet. Is the food any good?
A: Yes, especially the soups. It is quiet enough to study there.
B: Want to go tomorrow after class?

Dialogue C - Phone call

- A: Hi, this is Ali from Bright Solutions. Is Maria available?
B: She is in a meeting until three. Can I take a message?
A: Please ask her to call me back regarding the invoice.
B: Of course. I will let her know.

Extended Reading Passage

Read aloud once for gist, then again for vocabulary. Underline five new words and write your own summary paragraph.

Effective language learning depends on consistent exposure and active use. Many learners spend years studying grammar rules without speaking regularly, which creates a gap between knowledge and performance. Research suggests that daily contact with meaningful input - podcasts, articles, conversations, films with subtitles - builds the mental patterns needed for fluent speech. Output matters too: writing short paragraphs, recording yourself, and joining discussions force your brain to retrieve vocabulary under time pressure, which strengthens long-term memory.

Another key factor is error tolerance. Advanced speakers make mistakes; the goal is communication, not perfection. Keep a personal error log: note recurring problems (prepositions, articles, word order) and review them weekly. Pair study with real tasks - emails, presentations, travel - so new language serves a purpose. Finally, set measurable goals: learn twenty collocations this month, hold a ten-minute conversation twice a week, or finish one graded reader. Small, steady progress beats occasional marathon sessions.

Error Correction Exercises

Find and fix the mistake in each sentence. Answers are in parentheses.

1. She don't like spicy food. (doesn't)
2. I have been to Paris last year. (went - specific past time)
3. He is more taller than his brother. (taller - remove more)
4. We discussed about the problem. (discussed the - no about)
5. She suggested me to apply. (suggested that I apply)
6. I am agree with you. (I agree)

7. He explained me the rules. (explained the rules to me)
8. The informations are useful. (information - uncountable)
9. I look forward to meet you. (to meeting)
10. She is married with a lawyer. (married to)
11. I have a news for you. (some news - uncountable)
12. He did a mistake. (made a mistake)
13. We must to finish today. (must finish)
14. She is boring of the lecture. (bored by / bored with)
15. I am here since three hours. (have been here for)
16. He said that he will come. (would come - reported speech)
17. The children is playing outside. (children are)
18. I am used to wake up early. (used to waking up)
19. She is responsible of the team. (responsible for)
20. We need discuss this later. (need to discuss)

Sentence Building Practice

Combine the prompts into full sentences. Example: [weather / bad / stay home]
-> Because the weather was bad, we decided to stay home.

1. [deadline / tight / work / weekend]
2. [not familiar / software / ask / colleague]
3. [train / delayed / arrive / late]
4. [research / shows / exercise / improves / memory]
5. [although / tired / finish / assignment]
6. [if / more time / learn / second language]
7. [manager / praised / team / hard work]
8. [before / presentation / rehearse / twice]
9. [customer / complained / slow / service]
10. [since / moved / city / made / friends]
11. [unless / study / regularly / forget / vocabulary]
12. [despite / rain / match / continued]
13. [recommend / book / anyone / interested / history]
14. [while / waiting / bus / read / article]
15. [as soon as / hear / news / call / me]

Four-Week Study Plan

Use this plan to study McGraw-Hill Conversational American English in daily 30-45 minute sessions.

Week 1 - Foundations

Days 1-2: Skim the guide and list unknown words. Days 3-4: Study one core chapter and summarize it in your own words. Days 5-7: Do practice exercises aloud; record yourself if possible.

Week 2 - Active Practice

Days 8-10: Focus on your weakest section; redo examples without looking. Days 11-12: Explain the material to a friend or aloud alone. Days 13-14: Mixed review from all sections.

Week 3 - Real Usage

Days 15-17: Use new language in real tasks. Days 18-19: Read or listen to authentic English on

the same topic. Days 20-21: Write 300 words applying what you learned.

Week 4 - Consolidation

Days 22-24: Timed practice under exam or workplace conditions. Days 25-26: Fix weak areas using notes and answer keys. Days 27-28: Final review before moving to advanced material.

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